



Chrome 57 update

Battery optimisation and lower power consumption for background tabs.
<http://dgit.in/Chrome57>



Heater for fingers?

Envavo has designed the Heatbuff, which is basically a heater for your fingers.
<http://dgit.in/EnvavoH>

sky from one planet, they would spot the other planets as massive orbs on the night sky. While this sounds fantastic for aesthetic and romantic appeal, the main significance of this discovery is that the planetary forces would react with each other, because of the proximity.

Because of the forces interlocking, the planets, they may not exhibit rotation on their individual axes. This is a hindrance in our hopeful calculations of spotting life in the TRAPPIST-1 system. It is quite possible that without rotational movement, the planets in the habitable zone may experience day on one half and night on the other for eternity. This would further lead to vicious winds and devastating tidal waves (if these planets contain water) on the night half of the planet, making it unsuitable for supporting life as we know it.

Other significances of the TRAPPIST discovery also lies in the nature of the solar system. An ongoing study by researchers at Harvard University has claimed that the proximity of all the planets mean interplanetary panspermia is highly probable, or maybe even possible. Interplanetary panspermia is the hypothesis that life can exist across wider zones of the universe, spread by agents like meteoroids and comets. When it comes to the TRAPPIST-1 system, panspermia seems even more possible because of how the planets are lined up, and this further increases the chance for more planets to support life.

How are these planets discovered?

The first peg in the discovery of the TRAPPIST-1 system was the discovery of the star back in 1999 by 2MASS, one of the most ambitious space research projects. 2MASS surveyed the entire sky in the infrared spectrum. Subsequent studies were taken up by Prof. Gillon and his team at the University of Liege, who used the Chile-based TRAPPIST to make observations in 2015 based on the 2MASS J23062928-0502285 star discovered in 1999.

Subsequent studies and observations also involved the Spitzer Space Telescope and the Very Large Telescope, both belonging to NASA, following which

the announcement was made in February 2017. Data from the Spitzer telescope also relayed planetary sizes of those in the TRAPPIST-1 system, which have given astronauts a first estimate of the mass of each of these planets. Six of the seven discovered planets are being said to be rocky in composition, and the last one may be gaseous, falling on the outer edge of the system.

Further observations and studies are being made to make more confirmed calculations on these planets, and NASA's Hubble Space Telescope has initiated observation of the planets to study the atmospheric compositions. Most of these discoveries follow a similar path of discovery with the Kepler telescope being particularly prolific in the discovery of the planets. Until now, about 15 rocky exoplanets have been spotted orbiting stars in the habitable zone, the most notable of which till date was the Kepler-452b.

Discovered in 2015, the planet orbits a Sun-like star nearly 1,400 light years away, and is presently being studied by observatories and researchers.

Is mankind really a multi-planetary species?

Dangers surrounding the longevity of Earth has been at the back of our minds for a long time now, and that has brought out the all-important question – is mankind a multi-planetary species?

Thousands of science fiction novels and movies have suggested the presence of intelligent humanoid entities in

faraway solar systems, who somehow muster the ability to understand human speech, context, compassion and more such specifics. Wishful thinking aside, it may be highly improbable to think of life forms existing in different stellar systems in a similar way as it exists here.

Mankind, however, has lately set its sight on Mars, with some of the greatest minds in the world targeting to set up colonies in the red planet in the near future. There is a need for mankind to be a multi-planetary species, and that primarily spawns from the fact that our universe grows on complexity. From our perception of the universe, and not the other way round, complexity is a way of evolution that ensures greater heights to be reached in future generations.

As a result, converting mankind into a multi-planetary species is crucial to ensure that our branch of evolution can continue even in the incident of a gargantuan calamity that can threaten life on Earth. This would ensure that evolution continues for mankind, and much time and devotion is to be spent on ensuring the survival of all branches of mankind for as long as possible. As celebrated astrophysicist Carl Sagan once stated, "We are a way for the cosmos to know itself."

Mankind is what defines the meaning and significance of interstellar discoveries, and it is this, apart from evolutionary needs, that make mankind the perfect fit for being a multi-planetary species.

Incidentally, at a nearby distance and with seemingly optimum conditions



Here's how our present home compares to possible future ones